

Accessibility -- Built Environment

Verbatim excerpts from official Indian government sources. Each excerpt is cited with source document, URL, and page number. No content is paraphrased.

Source list:

R5.1 Accessible India Campaign / Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan -- *DEPwD* (included)

<https://depwd.gov.in/accessible-india-campaign/>

R5.2 DEPwD Accessibility Standards -- *DEPwD* (included)

<https://depwd.gov.in/accessibility-standards/>

R5.1 -- Accessible India Campaign / Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan

Source: DEPwD | URL: <https://depwd.gov.in/accessible-india-campaign/>

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Accessible India Campaign | Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPwD) | India
Accessible India Campaign

Accessible India Campaign (Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan)

The Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPwD) launched the
Accessible India Campaign (Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan)

as a nationwide initiative to achieve universal accessibility for Persons with Disabilities (PwDs) on
December 3, 2015.

Built Environment Accessibility

An accessible physical environment benefits everyone, not only persons with disabilities. Efforts must be made to remove barriers in both indoor and outdoor spaces, including schools, healthcare facilities, and workplaces.

Transportation System Accessibility

Transportation plays a vital role in independent living. Persons with Disabilities (PwDs), like all citizens, depend on accessible transportation systems. This includes air travel, buses, taxis, and railways.

Information and Communication Ecosystem Accessibility

Access to information empowers individuals and enables full participation in everyday life. Information must be provided in accessible formats so that no one is excluded. This includes access to price labels, event information, healthcare materials, train schedules, and web content. The campaign aims to eliminate societal barriers related to infrastructure and information formats. Targets in this area focus on improving website accessibility, audiovisual media, and the availability of sign language interpretation.

Enhancing the proportion of accessible and usable public documents and websites that meet internationally recognized accessibility standards

This objective ensures that public documents published from a specified year onward and all existing government websites comply with standards set by the International Organization for Standardization (ISO), specifically

ISO/IEC

40500:2012 – Information Technology – W3C Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.0. Public documents include laws, regulations, reports, forms, and brochures issued by national and subnational governments.

Enhancing the pool of sign language interpreters

Increasing the number of trained and certified sign language interpreters to ensure inclusive communication across public and private services.

Enhancing the proportion of daily captioning and sign-language interpretation of public television news programmes

Ensuring that more public television news programs provide daily captioning and sign-language interpretation in accordance with agreed accessibility standards. Public television refers to content produced, funded, or supported by the government.

SATYA – Accessibility Testing Tool

SATYA is a Google Chrome extension designed to assist in testing and evaluating website accessibility. The tool helps identify accessibility issues in web pages in alignment with established accessibility guidelines, supporting the development of inclusive and user-friendly digital platforms. SATYA can be used by developers, designers, and content managers to assess compliance with accessibility standards and enhance the overall accessibility of government websites.

SATYA Tool Link

SATYA Tool Website

Apply for Empanelment of Access Auditor

Accessible India Campaign sub-scheme guidelines

Title

Date

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Expression of Interest (EOI) Phase 2 for the empanelment of web accessibility auditors with the Department

10/10/2025

Accessible Version :

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(622 KB)

Expression of Interest (EOI) Phase 2 for the empanelment of Built Environment auditors with the Department

10/10/2025

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(806 KB)

Revised Guidelines of Accessible India Campaign Sub-scheme of SIPDA

31/10/2023

Accessible Version :

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(503 KB)

Standards/Guidelines notified under the Rights for Persons with Disabilities Rules 2017

Title

Date

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Accessibility standards and Guidelines for Banking Sector

02/07/2024

Accessible Version :

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(746 KB)

Accessibility Guidelines and Standards for Higher Education Institutions and Universities by Department of Higher Education, Ministry of Education.

25/06/2024

Accessible Version :

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(10 MB)

Accessibility Code for Educational Institutions by Dept. of School Education and Literacy, Ministry of Education

20/06/2024

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(5 MB)

Accessibility Standards and Guidelines for MHA Specific Built Infrastructures & Associated Services for Police Stations, Prisons & Disaster Mitigation Centres by Ministry of Home Affairs

22/03/2024

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

Guidelines on accessibility of Indian Railway stations and facilities at stations for differently abled persons (Divyangjan) and passengers with reduced mobility by Ministry of Railways

08/03/2024

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(4 MB)

Guidelines on accessible and inclusive piped water supply for persons with disabilities and for other population groups with access challenges by Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation

15/02/2024

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(4 MB)

Guidelines for Accessibility Standards in Port Sector by Ministry of Port Shipping and Waterways

15/02/2024

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(4 MB)

Rural Sector Specific Harmonized accessibility Standards/ guidelines by Ministry of Rural Development

16/11/2023

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(1 MB)

Accessibility standards for Health Care by Ministry of Health and family Affairs

09/08/2023

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(5 MB)

The accessibility standards and guidelines for Civil Aviation 2022 by Ministry of Civil Aviation

21/07/2023

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

Guidelines on accessible sports complex and residential facilities for sports persons with dis

abilities by Department of Sports

17/07/2023

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(4 MB)

Culture sector specific harmonised accessibility standards by Ministry of Culture

13/07/2023

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(2 MB)

Accessibility for the ICT products and services (Part I and II) by Bureau of Indian Standards(Department of Consumer Affairs)

11/06/2023

Accessible Version :

[View](#)

(5 MB)

Harmonised guidelines & standards for universal accessibility in India 2021 by Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

05/06/2023

Accessible Version :

View

Accessibility for the ICT products and services

11/05/2023

Accessible Version :

View

Accessibility Standards for Bus Body Code by Ministry of Road Transport and highways

16/09/2016

Accessible Version :

View

(5 MB)

Number of Ministries/Departments that have adopted the guidelines/standards of other Ministry/Department as notified under Rule 15 of the RPwD Rules.

RPwD Rule Clause (as Amended)

Standards/Guidelines

Concerned Ministry/Department

No separate guidelines

Adopted BIS Standards: Accessibility for ICT Products and Services (Part I and II)

Department of Telecommunication

No separate guidelines

Adopted MoHUA's Harmonised Guidelines 2021 and BIS Standards: Accessibility for ICT Products and Services (Part I and II)

Department of Law and Justice

No separate guidelines

Adopted BIS Standards: Accessibility for ICT Products and Services (Part I and II)

Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Guidelines awaited for notification in Gazette of India by concerned Ministry/Department – Action to be taken by the concerned Department/Ministry

Serial Number

Name of the Guidelines

Date of Public Consultation

Date of Completed CCPD Consultation

Concerned Ministry/Department

1

Accessibility Guidelines for Bus Terminals and Bus Stops

16 November 2021

03 September 2021

Ministry of Road Transport and Highways

2

Accessible Tourism Guidelines for India 2022

15 June 2022

31 August 2022

Ministry of Tourism

3

Accessibility Standards for TV Programmes for Hearing and Visually Impaired

3 November 2021

Draft accessibility standards/guidelines for persons with disabilities under the Broadcasting Services

Regulation Bill, 2023 have been circulated for public consultation. CCPD consultation was completed on 2 May 2024.

Ministry of Information and Broadcasting

4

Accessibility Guidelines for Pension, Other Financial Institutions and Insurance Sector

Pension Reforms

30 May 2023

25 August 2023

Department of Financial Services

Insurance

9 May 2023

15 May 2024

Financial Institutions

25 October 2023

13 June 2024

Initiatives by DEPwD

Title

Date

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List of 10 Basic Features of Accessibility for Buildings.

22/11/2023

Accessible Version :

View

(167 KB)

Accessibility in Public Centric Buildings (PPT).

22/11/2023

Accessible Version :

View

(1 MB)

Example of Accessibility in Public Centric Building (Vedio).

22/11/2023

Accessible Version :

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Empanelled Access Auditor

Title

Date

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Consolidated List of Empanelled Web Accessibility Auditors with Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, Ministry of Social Justice Empowerment, Govt. of India.

25/03/2026

Accessible Version :

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(647 KB)

List 4 of Empanelled Web Accessibility Auditors with Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, MSJE, Govt. of India.

26/11/2025

Accessible Version :

View

(403 KB)

Empanelled Access Auditor with Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, Govt. of India.

08/10/2025

Accessible Version :

View

(496 KB)

Expression of Interest (EOI) Phase 2 for the empanelment of web accessibility auditors with the Department

10/10/2025

Accessible Version :

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(622 KB)

Expression of Interest (EOI) Phase 2 for the empanelment of Built Environment auditors with the Department

10/10/2025

Accessible Version :

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(806 KB)

List 3 of Empanelled Web Accessibility Auditors with Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities, (25.0.2025) Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, Govt. of India.

25/09/2025

Accessible Version :

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(265 KB)

List 2 of Empanelled Web Accessibility Auditors with the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (07.07.2025), Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, Govt. of India

06/08/2025

Accessible Version :

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(23 KB)

List 1 of Empanelled Web Accessibility Auditors with the Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (04.02.2025)

04/02/2025

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(486 KB)

R5.2 -- DEPwD Accessibility Standards

Source: DEPwD | URL: <https://depwd.gov.in/accessibility-standards/>

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Accessibility Standards | Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPwD) | India
Accessibility Standards

Publish Date :

October 26, 2023

SI No.

Title

Document

1.

Draft Accessibility Standards/Guidelines for MHA specific built infrastructure and Associated Services for Police Stations, Prisons and Disaster Mitigation Centers

View

2.

Accessibility Guidelines for Bus terminals/Bus stops- Public Consultation reg.

View

3.

Accessibility Standards for TV Programmes for Hearing Impaired – seeking comments from General Public and Stakeholders by Ministry of Information and Broadcasting

View